



KAKAMEGA PROJECT REPORT 2022

Project Theme: FUTURE IN A MILLION TREES

Date: 26th to 29th of May 2022.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

We take this opportunity to thank the Almighty God for good health and protection throughout the planning and execution phase.

Special acknowledgement to German Imaging Technologies, YMCA Kenya, WATU Credit, Hale Education Group and Interior 360 General Trading LLC for your financial support which boosted the organization ability to realize its objective. Sincere appreciations to Masinde Muliro University of Science and Technology administration for the provision of 60 student's volunteers.

We also thank

1. Kakamega County Government, Department of Environment
2. National Environment Management Authority
3. Youths For Green Action Kenya Volunteers\
4. Masinde Muliro University Administration and Volunteers
5. St Jerome Savane Polytechnic
6. Shitoli Polytechnic
7. Kambiri Community
8. Bondeni primary
9. Egerton University Administartion
10. Media Team: Tandaza Radio, Luhya TV, KTN News, Radio Maisha, Standard Newspaper, Citizen TV, West FM, West TV, Nyota Radio and Nyota TV

Executive Summary

Youths For Green Action Kenya is a non-Governmental organization (NGO) registered under section 10 of the Non-Governmental Organizations Co-ordination Board of Kenya has recently carried out an environmental conservation initiative precisely a tree planting exercise in Kakamega County. The Organization partnered with German Imaging Technologies (GIT), Kakamega County Government, National Environment Management Authority (NEMA) and Masinde Muliro University of Science and Technology (MMUST) in an effort to improve rural, school and urban environmental conditions and to educate and empower local communities on environmental concerns. The project was carried out between 26th May, 2022 to 29th May, 2022 with external funding from German Imaging Technologies (GIT). The project was carried in mainly three Sub Counties namely, Shinyalu, Ikolomani, and Lurambi Sub County. In every Sub-County specific target place was chosen including Shitoli Polytechnic and Kambiri Community in Shinyalu Sub-County, St Jerome Savane Polytechnic in Ikolomani and Bondeni primary in Lurambi Sub-County. A total of 10,000 tree seedlings were planted where Indigenous trees totaled to 4000, Exotic trees 5700 and fruit trees 300.

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LIST OF ACRONYMS

GIT: German Imaging Technologies

NEMA: National Environment Management Authority

MMUST: Masinde Muliro University of Science and Technology

YGAK: Youths For Green Action Kenya

NGO: Non-Governmental Organization

SDG: Sustainable Development Goals

Table 1: PROJECT COMPLETION SUMMARY

Project Title	FUTURE IN A MILLION TREES	
Lead Organization	YOUTHS FOR GREEN ACTION KENYA	
Partner Organizations	Organization	Key Staff
	German Imaging Technologies	Dr. Sassan Dieter Khatib-Shahidi
	National Environment Management Authority	Mr. John Maniafu
	Masinde Muliro University of Science and Technology	Mr. Oscar Waswa
	Kakamega County Government	Mr. Eugene Milimo Wamalwa
Project Purpose	To plant 10,000 tree seedlings.	
Location	Kakamega County	
Start Date	26 TH May, 2022	
End Date	29 TH May,2022	
Media Coverage	Tandaza Radio, Luhya TV, KTN News, Radio Maisha, Standard Newspaper, Citizen TV, West FM, West TV, Nyota Radio and Nyota TV	

YOUTHS FOR GREEN ACTION KENYA – KAKAMEGA PROJECT 2022 REPORT
CONDUCTED BETWEEN 26TH TO 29TH MAY 2022.

1.0 ORGANIZATIONS BACKGROUND INFORMATION

Youths For Green Action Kenya is a registered non-Governmental organization under section 10 of the Non- Governmental Organizations Co-ordination Board of Kenya. The organization aims at offering a holistic approach for community development in Kenya based on the principle of empowerment, inclusion, self-determination and collective action towards the environment and climate action. This is achievable through research that underpins national programs to scale up the use of trees within farming systems in Kenya and then scale out success to relevant agro ecological zones in Kenya. The organization is dedicated to environmental improvements that foster a sustainable future and lead to social and economic empowerment in the community we do live. Our vision is to become the leading Non-Governmental Organization in promoting environmental conservation in Kenya

The organization has been spearheading environmental conservation efforts since October 2018 with members across various institutions of higher learning in Kenya, though it has been founded and nurtured in Egerton University. In various project the organization has been partnering and receiving support from the institution for implementation of the projects. The organization has been undertaking voluntary initiatives to promote sustainable development by conducting environmental workshops, capacity building, planting of trees, engaging in environmental clean-ups, visiting rehabilitation centers and children's homes among other activities which create a positive impact in society in general. The organization has carried out various community service projects in various counties and towns including; Narok county, Mombasa County, Naivasha, Njoro sub-county and now Kakamega County.

1.1 Introduction

Forests are today recognized as an indisputable solution to combating climate change, an additional support to the necessary reduction of our carbon footprint. Aside from the environmental benefits, they provide nature-based economic and social solutions that can help meet a vast range of planetary changes. For a decade now, there have been a wide spread international campaigns and hashtags placing forests, soil and water at the center of environmental preservation. Taking heed of the global Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) number 13 on the Climate Action, Youths For Green Action Kenya (YAK) took forward steps in the conservation of environment through environmental contribution to the forested areas such as Kakamega County towards protecting the environment. SDG aims at achieving “1 Trillion Trees” to conserve, restore and plant one trillion trees by 2030.

Kenya is endowed with a wide range of forest ecosystems ranging from montane rainforests, savannah woodlands, dry forests, coastal forests and mangroves. Forests play critical ecological, social, cultural, and economic functions. They are crucial in providing basic human needs and habitat for wildlife, biodiversity and soil conservation, regulating water flows and sequestering carbon dioxide. Sustainable forest management is at the very core of Kenya’s social and economic wellbeing as most of the country’s economic sectors rely on environment based resources for their sustenance. Kenya’s forest cover is estimated to be about 7.4% of the total land area, which is far from the recommended global minimum of 10%.

Further, the forest sector is estimated to contribute about 7 billion Kenya Shillings to the economy and employ over 50,000 people directly and another 300,000 indirectly. Forest ecosystems also enhance landscape resilience to climate change. In the country’s water towers, for example, forests and trees provide environmental services that include water quality and quantity, reduction of soil erosion, and creation of micro-climatic conditions that maintain and/or improve productivity. From a

climate change perspective, forests are known to be among the most effective sinks of greenhouse gases that cause climate change.

Kakamega County is at the western part of Kenya and majorly known to have beautiful scenes of the forests and a general cool temperature accompanied with long rains. However, like all other parts of Kenya, Western part is affected by deforestation owing to human activities of cutting down of trees and settlement. This puts to risk growth of the economy with agriculture seasons affected due to low and unpredictable rainfalls. The pollution from industries has as well put the life of residence at a risk. There is a need of environmental education to promote ecological civilization and positive attitudes towards environment and consumption patterns.

In addition, there is a continued depletion of forests and cutting down of trees at homesteads for commercial use. These further risks country's environmental security which adversely impact on national productivity.

Owing to these factors and the experience gained from other projects, Youths for Green Action Kenya carried out a tree planting activity in the County dubbed ***“Future in a million trees”*** planting 10, 000 trees seedlings where Indigenous trees totaled to 4000, Exotic trees 5700 and fruit trees 300, making it a total of 82,000 seedlings planted by the organization so far. Youths For Green Action Kenya conducted the tree planting exercise alongside environmental awareness amongst the community in Kakamega to mitigate these challenges. The project employed a participatory approach while involving the local community to enhance sustainability and reach a wider spectrum in its environmental conservation campaigns. The project also involved workshop training on youth's role on sustainable development, environmental conservation and electronic waste control.

1.2 Project Objectives

1. To promote local participation and sustainable use of environment in Kakamega County
2. To promote the culture of volunteerism and community service.
3. To enhance youth empowerment and development.

1.3 Project Outputs

The outputs achieved by the project implementation are as follows:

- Planted 10,000 tree seedlings where Indigenous trees totaled to 4000, Exotic trees 5700 and fruit trees 300.
- Established linkages with the local community and academic institutions such as MMUST, Shitoli Polytechnic, St Jerome Savane and Bondeni Primary.
- Conducted a capacitybuilding and training session for 120 volunteers from YAK and MMUST
- Established linkages with organizations and government institutions such as NEMA, GIT and Kakamega County Government.

1.4 Project Implementation

The project employed volunteer labor from Youths for Green Action Kenya and MMUST students. The organization also embraced a local community participation to enhance ownership, acceptance and sustainability of the project. The Organization partnered with German Imaging Technologies (GIT), Kakamega County Government, National Environment Management Authority (NEMA) and Masinde Muliro University of Science and Technology (MMUST) in execution of its plan.

For publicity and awareness, the project incorporated a media coverage which was actualized through the presence of various media stations both local and national stations including Tandaza Radio, Luhya TV, KTN News, Radio Maisha, Standard Newspaper, Citizen TV, West FM, West TV, Nyota Radio and Nyota TV.

2.0 PROJECTS ACTIVITIES

2.1 TRAINING AND CAPACITY BUILDING

The organization objectives is embedded in protecting the planet from degradation, including through sustainable consumption and production, sustainably managing its natural resources and taking urgent action on climate change, so that it can support the needs of the present and future generations. To realize its objectives, the organization conducted a day workshop devoted to training, demonstration and provision of knowledge and information on tree planting, Toner Cartridges collection, handling and storage and other environmental conservation measures to its volunteers. Presentations on the need to conserve the environment were presented by the NEMA authorities present whose emphasis were majorly on the need to shift focus from “tree planting to tree growing” to ensure sustainability and long-term impact. On the toner Cartridges collection the presentation was made by the GIT team whose emphasis also focused on how to use the toner cartridges and their benefits in institutions and organizations.



GIT Presentation during the workshop



Volunteers asking question during Nema Presentation

2.2 TREE PLANTING

The project was carried in mainly three Sub Counties namely, Shinyalu, Ikolomani, and Lorambi Sub County. In every Sub-County specific target place was chosen including Shitoli Polytechnic and Kambiri Community in Shinyalu Sub-County, St Jerome Savane Polytechnic in Ikolomani and Bondeni primary in Lurambi Sub-County. A total of 10,000 tree seedlings were planted where Indigenous trees totaled to 4000, Exotic trees 5700 and fruit trees 300.

2.2.1 BONDENI PRIMARY

“Nature needs Little Environmental Champions”. Children play an integral role in protecting an environment when they are well equipped with necessary knowledge to care for the planet. Children become empowered, flourished and educated when environmental matters are incorporated in their upbringing and social life. Bondeni Primary School is a Public – Primary School, located near Kakamega Town, Lurambi Sub County in Kakamega County. It is one of the highly populated public schools in Kakamega Municipality. The population of the school and space to plant the trees is fascinating for the organization to carry its initiative in the school.

The organization planted 1500 tree seedlings in the school inclusive of fruit trees such as mangoes, passion fruits and avocados. The trees will along way to provide a serene environment for learning in the institution and provide fruits for students in future. The initiative has also impacted a positive change to student to draw their attention to care for the environment through caring for the trees planted in their school. This initiative is a start of a campaign to encourage young generation to preserve a sound environment for the future.



Bondeni primary school pupils taking tree seedlings to the planting site



Deputy Head teacher Bondeni primary school planting a tree

2.2.2 KAMBIRI COMMUNITY

“Success of projects and programs in a community depends on the level of involvement”. The tree planting activity also stretched to Shinyalu Sub-County where Kambiri Community was the main target location. The organization employed local community participation in the place as one of the key development principle. Community participation in tree planting activities in an effort to increase tree cover is a significant aspect in encouraging community interaction and improve community spirit, fostering a sense of ownership in communities. In addition, community participation in tree planting blocks possibilities of conflicts, rejection, increases acceptance and reduces incidences of vandalism. It also ensures sustainability of the exercise since the locals take the task to manage and protect the planted seedlings.

Moreover, the organization took a step to empower and educate local community on the need to conserve the environment in their local area. The project sought to improve the environmental awareness of the local community in Kambiri through a participatory approach in tree planting. The local community participated in the process of the planting of trees seedlings and the maintenance thereafter. The exercise attracted approximately 100 Kambiri locals with the zeal to plant and conserve the environment. The community mobilization strategy raised and formed a closer relationship of the organization and the community to increase awareness with regard to the conservation of the environment.

The organization planted 5000 tree seedlings in Kambiri Community along river Nandamanywa in Ingolomosio village. The community chose to plant tree seedlings along river Ingolomosio in an effort to reinstate it from drying up. The community’s campaign in restoring the river is through cutting down the eucalyptus trees along the river while replacing them with the indigenous trees. Statistically, the blue gum trees are believed to consume a lot of water and also kills off surrounding

plant life through releasing chemicals to the soil which is a major contributing factor of river dry-ups. The planted tree seedlings will help to restore the ecological equilibrium in Kambiri community, contribute to the Community's campaign of greening the place which will result in a cleaner and greener environment and healthier communities.



Area assistant chief Kambiri Location planting tree during the occasion



Volunteers heading downstream to plant the tree seedlings.



GIT Partners engaging in also planting the trees



Trees seedlings planted in Kambiri Location

2.2.3 SHITOLI POLYTECHNIC

Shitoli Youth Polytechnic is a Youth Polytechnic in Kenya. It is a Public Youth Polytechnic located at Shirumba, Shinyalu Sub County, Kakamega County, Kenya. Trees play an important ecological role within the educational environment, as well as support improved public health and beautifies a place. Youths For Green Action Kenya in partnership with GIT and other partners took an initiative to plant 2000 tree seedlings in Shitoli Polytechnic. Among the trees the trees planted were 100 fruit trees. The aim of carrying this initiative in Shitoli Polytechnic was to increase environmental awareness and to foster schools' and students' engagement in improving their environment, by actively participating in the process. The trees planted will go a long way to combat climate change issues and contribute to the Nation's goal of attaining a 10 % forest cover.



Volunteers planting tree seedlings at shitoli polytechnic



A group photo of volunteers holding tree seedlings at shitoli polytechnic

2.2.4 ST JEROME SAVANE POLYTECHNIC

“Learning in natural environments boosts performance, enhance critical thinking, and increase enthusiasm for learning.” St Jerome Savane Polytechnic is a public institution located in Ikolomani Sub County, Sabane Sub-location, Iguhu Location in Ikolomani Division Kakamega County. Volunteers together with St Jerome polytechnic students planted 1500 tree seedlings inclusive of fruit trees and indigenous trees which will go a long way in creating a serene environment for learning in the institution and help combat climate change issues. The participative approach to tree planting encourages sustainability of the initiative as the students will take charge to care for the tree seedlings in the institution afterwards.



St Jerome Savane principal participating in the tree plantation occasion



Volunteers and the polytechnic students heading to the planting site



Volunteers and the polytechnic students planting tree seedlings.

Team Building

Team building is one of the best ways for groups to improve in social engagement, satisfaction, and enthusiasm. It enhances volunteers ability to improve in their interpersonal connections when they participate in a social activity. Youths For Green Action Kenya volunteers were able to carry out team building exercises during the days of the project to ensure the enthusiasm for the project participation is attained. The exercises were important in cultivating enthusiastic and committed group. In addition, team building exercises ensured a heightened morale , productivity, collaboration and a high level of turnover in the projects activities.



3.0 CHALLENGES EXPERIENCED

- i. Late bookings of facilities to be used threatened the project preparation
- ii. Lesser period for project execution which inhibits executing of project activities with ease and per excellence.

4.0 CONCLUSION

Organizations great focus is achieving sustainable development through meeting human

Development goals while sustaining the ability of natural systems to continue to provide the natural resources and ecosystem services upon which the economy and society depend. We understand this is a process and we focus on approaching it from local and regional levels with interest in robust economic and social progress with emphasis on the environment. Future in a Million Trees Initiative was worth an engaging, impactful and winning initiative that seeks to contribute to the environment positively.

5.0 RECOMMENDATIONS

Timely payments to allow booking of facilities in advance to ease project participation. Increase number of days to allow more activities done with regard to environmental conservation and preservation

Appendices





